VARSHA THAKUR
Chapel Hill, NC 27514
E. varshathakur0525@gmail.com | M. +1 984 291 4950

November 2, 2026

World Bank Group
Digital Applications Department

Re: Digital & AI Skills Specialist (req38713)

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Digital & AI Skills Specialist position (req38713) in the Digital Applications Department. For six years I designed learning pathways and materials for government education programs across Africa and India, often in fragile settings. I am a master's student at UNC-Chapel Hill, a Rotary Peace Fellow, and am currently interning with UNICEF's Office of Internal Audit and Investigations. My research focuses on AI literacy, ethics and governance and I broadly work at the intersection of education, technology an policy. AI is changing what work looks like, and this role brings both strands together to help governments turn AI readiness into skills people can use.

My recent academic work builds on my experience in education delivery to address emerging AI skills needs. For my Peace Lab project, I designed an AI literacy and ethics education proposal for government schools in Bihar, supported by stakeholder analysis and a two-year implementation roadmap. The model proposes training teachers and engaging local youth as facilitators, connecting digital inclusion with employment opportunities in underserved communities. This semester, I am developing an AI coaching tool for small business owners who cannot afford specialized staff. Drawing on adult learning principles, the tool guides owners through business diagnostics and practical 30–60–90-day action plans to improve their operations and profitability.

Alongside these projects, I co-lead the ethics group of UNC's student AI committee, where we are reviewing syllabi, student survey findings, and the usage and legal policies of major AI companies to identify gaps in institutional AI governance. I am also currently interning with UNICEF's Office of Internal Audit and Investigations. Beyond my assigned responsibilities, I tested an internal AI transcription tool, documented five issues, and provided feedback that informed fixes in its subsequent release.

Previously, at NewGlobe Education, I progressed from Associate to Deputy Managing Editor, supporting government education programs including RwandaEQUIP, EdoBEST in Nigeria, Andhra Pradesh, and STAR Education in Manipur. During COVID-19 school closures, I worked on more than 900 radio lessons reaching over 70,000 students across African countries. During the 2023 Manipur crisis, I helped deliver textbooks to nearly 5,000 displaced children in military camps. I also led a 12-member team, established GenAI usage standards, trained colleagues in prompt engineering, and strengthened quality assurance processes, reducing print material revision cycles by 40%.

Earlier, as a political analyst in Uttar Pradesh, I worked with legislators and civil servants, prepared state-level reports, and trained field volunteers. Together, these experiences have prepared me to work across policy, technology adoption, and government program implementation, while collaborating with stakeholders across disciplines and institutions.

I would be thrilled with the opportunity to contribute to the World Bank Group's digital and AI skills frameworks, country diagnostics, operational toolkits, and knowledge products.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Varsha Thakur